

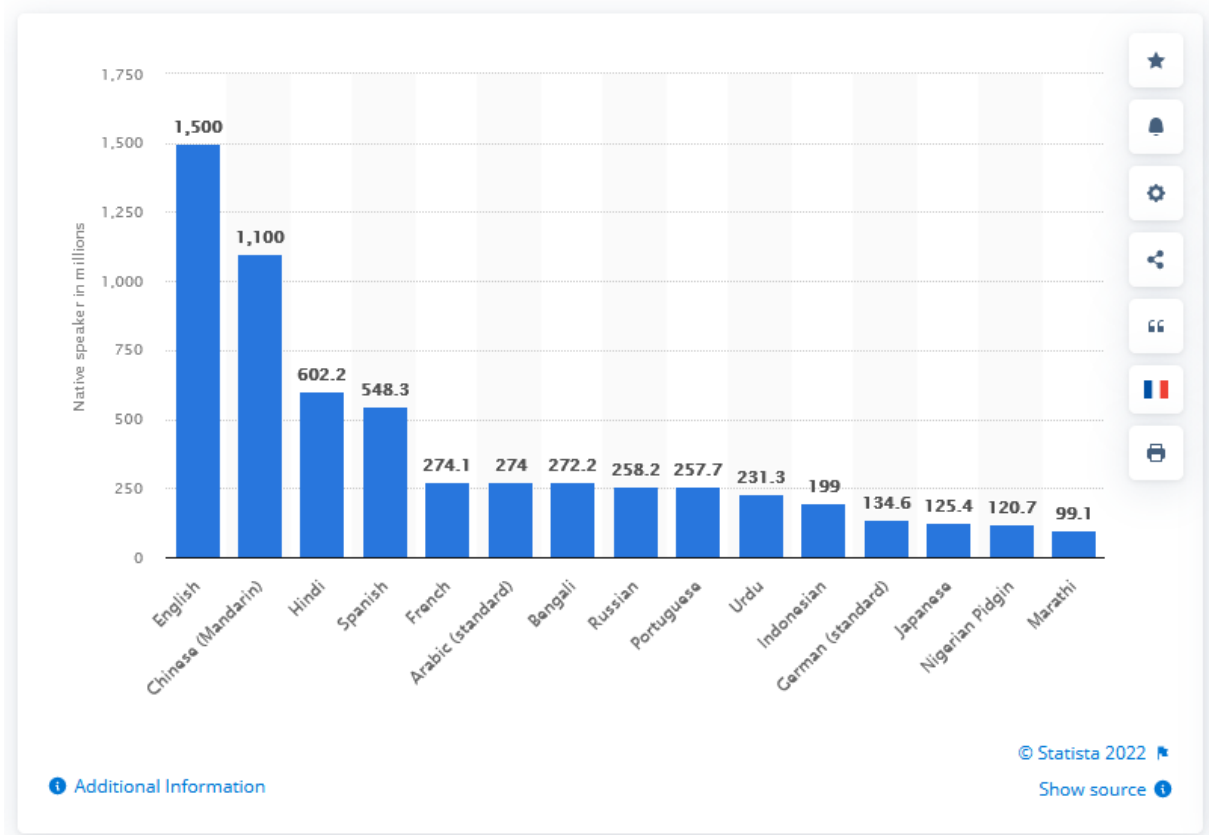
## Ausarbeitung Matura Themengebiete

### How to improve your English (language year, stay abroad, gap year)

English is the world's most widely spoken language, though the majority of speakers are not native. Of the approximately 1.5 billion people who speak English, less than 400 million use it as a first language. That means over 1 billion speak it as a secondary language.

### The most spoken languages worldwide in 2022

*(by speakers in millions)*



These statistics don't make it surprising, that improving your skills in the world language may be something useful to do. Almost everywhere in the world, you can communicate with other people by speaking the English language.

There are several ways to improve your English skills, though the four core skills to always keep in mind are **reading, writing, speaking, and listening**.

Improving your English has never been as easy as it is now. The following list covers the in my opinion most effective ways to do so.

## **Learning apps**

There are several learning apps that can easily help you improve your English skills, for example Duolingo or Babbel. One lesson only takes around 10 to 20 minutes, which is the perfect duration to stay concentrated and still get an effective learning session in at the same time. Doing this every will improve your English pretty quickly.

## **Movies or videos in English**

Watching YouTube videos in English is what has been working for me to continuously improve my English skills over the past couple of years. This is very effective, because it helps you to get a feeling on how sentences are constructed, you learn new words and you learn the correct pronunciation of a lot of words. If you can't follow a movie or video when you first start doing this, you can add the subtitles for better understanding.

## **Language year**

A language year is a great opportunity to improve your skills in English. The advantages are that you speak English with other students every day, learning new words and their pronunciation. Unfortunately, you miss out on a lot of stuff that you would have learned in your home school.

## **Staying abroad**

With staying abroad, you get the same advantages that you get with a language year, without the disadvantage of missing out on stuff that you would have learned in your home school. If you find a workplace in an English-speaking country, I think this is the perfect opportunity to improve your English.

## **Tips**

Some tips to improve your English are

- Don't be afraid to make mistakes
- Practise every day
- Give yourself a long-term goal
- Know what works best for you
- Surround yourself in English